



Designing an Effective BBNJ Clearing-House Mechanism: Insights and Guidance Drawn from Comparable Tools

Executive summary: The BBNJ Clearing-House Mechanism (CLHM) plays a central role throughout the BBNJ Agreement. Properly implemented, the CLHM will greatly facilitate international cooperation, enhance transparency, and promote informed decision-making in the governance of marine biodiversity beyond national jurisdiction.

During the first PrepCom (14–25 April 2025), States expressed a preference for: i) an incremental approach to operationalizing the CLHM, including an interim or pilot phase; and ii) a functional approach that identifies and prioritizes functions across the main parts of the Agreement.

This briefing presents recommendations regarding the structure, functionality, and user interface of the BBNJ CLHM derived from an analysis of how other international agreements, arrangements, and processes have approached mechanisms for data sharing. The briefing identifies core functions of the CLHM that are common across the Agreement¹ and that should be prioritized in the initial pilot or interim phase, and identifies best practices for fulfilling those functions. Key findings include:

1. The BBNJ Agreement clearly articulates when, how, and with whom different types of information must be shared through the CLHM, establishing well-defined obligations that do not require additional interpretation by the PrepCom.
2. Important information exchange obligations under Parts II (MGRs), IV (EIAs) and V (CBTMT) begin to accrue when the Agreement enters into force, which may occur as soon as early 2026. It is therefore urgent that a pilot or interim CLHM be developed as soon as possible that enables States to fulfil imminent obligations, including mechanisms for:
 - uploading and downloading information;
 - notifying States Parties and others of the availability of information and deadlines;
 - ensuring data security;
 - establishing user modalities (e.g., who can upload and download information); and
 - providing live assistance to users in close to real time.
3. Most information published in the BBNJ CLHM can and should be made publicly available in real time through automated processes to promote transparency and ensure timely access to information by all stakeholders.
4. The core basic components are similar across all parts of the Agreement and are relatively straightforward to implement.

¹ Note: cross-cutting core components are the subject of this briefing. Additional functionalities will be necessary to implement CLHM functions unique to a specific part of the Agreement, such as the match-making function in capacity-building and the transfer of marine technology (CBTMT) (which could partially be implemented as an automatic function, but will likely require proactive human involvement to work effectively) and the automatic generation of a batch identifier when a pre-collection notification is received by the CLHM under Part II.

I. Introduction

While various parts of the BBNJ Agreement assign different tasks to the CLHM, Article 51(3)(a) summarizes its main function as to

“[s]erve as a centralized platform to enable Parties to access, provide and disseminate information with respect to activities taking place pursuant to the provisions of this Agreement....”

Based on desktop research and conversations with administrators and users of CLHM-like mechanisms under other international agreements and processes,² as well as with IT experts with experience creating and using interactive databases,³ this briefing:

- a. identifies key functions of the CLHM that are common across the various parts of the BBNJ Agreement and that should be addressed in an interim or pilot phase;
- b. identifies “backend”⁴ technical and IT-related elements that are essential to establishing a robust, user-friendly and secure CLHM; and
- c. highlights best practices, innovative modalities, and functional attributes to help inform the design and implementation of the CLHM.

II. Key functions of the BBNJ CLHM common to all parts of the Agreement

The basic functions of the CLHM are to:

- a. facilitate obligatory information sharing by providing a mechanism (a data platform) to receive information from Parties and others, store it, and provide means of accessing it; and
- b. provide a notification function⁵ to inform other Parties and stakeholders when various actions are undertaken.

These basic functions – providing a data sharing platform and a notification mechanism – are linked to obligations in the BBNJ articles presented in Table 1.

² The arrangements and processes evaluated inter alia include: the Antarctic Treaty System Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) Database, World Trade Organization (WTO), Joint CLHM Basel, Rotterdam and Stockholm (BRS) Conventions, the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) (Emergency Preparedness and Response Information Management System and the International Radiation Monitoring Information System), the Intergovernmental Science-Policy Platform on Biodiversity and Ecosystem Services (IPBES), the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD), the European Environment Agency (EEA), the International Labour Organization (ILO), the United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA), the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD), the Convention on Migratory Species (CMS), the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) Climate Technology Centre and Network (CTCN), and the Agreement on the Conservation of Cetaceans of the Black Sea, Mediterranean Sea and contiguous Atlantic Area (ACCOBAMS).

³ A separate briefing prepared by the High Seas Alliance addresses overall considerations on the institutional set-up of the CLHM.

⁴ “[T]he part of a computer system, piece of software, etc., where data is stored or processed rather than the parts that are seen and directly used by the user,” Cambridge Dictionary.

⁵ The term “notification” is used with varying meanings throughout the Agreement. In Part II, it principally refers to the submission of information by a Party to the CLHM, whereas in Parts III and IV it denotes the availability of information on the platform.

Table 1: Key functions assigned to the CLHM and corresponding articles of the BBNJ Agreement

Function	Relevant provisions	Articles
Database management/receiving and storing information/making information publicly available	Several provisions of the BBNJ Agreement require that information be shared and stored through the CLHM, including: Part II (MGRs): - Pre-collection information - Post-collection information - Information on any publications, patents, products, and/or revenue generated from MGRs or associated DSI - Information related to implementation Part IV (EIAs): - Decisions not to prepare an EIA - Draft EIA reports - EIA reports (including, when appropriate, under Article 29.5, reports of assessments conducted under other instruments/frameworks) - Views and recommendations by the STB, Parties, Indigenous Peoples and others - Decision documents - Monitoring and reviewing reports Part V (CBTMT): - Requests and opportunities for CBTMT in support of Parties obligations to ensure capacity-building and cooperate to achieve the transfer of marine technology - Cooperate at all levels (e.g., including private sector, civil society, and Indigenous Peoples and local communities as holders of traditional knowledge) and in all forms - Sharing and use of relevant data, information, knowledge, and research results - Sharing manuals, guidelines, and standards - General requirement to facilitate access to related know-how and expertise	Articles 12(2) and 12(4) Article 12(5) Article 12(8) Article 15(4) Articles 28(2)(a) and 28(2)(c) Articles 29(5) and 29(6) Articles 31(1)(a)(i) and 31(1)(a)(vi) Articles 33(3) and 33(5) Article 34(3) Article 36(2) Articles 37(4)(d), 37(5), and 37(6) Article 41(2) Article 42(1) Articles 44(1)(a), 44(1)(b), and 44(1)(f) Article 51(3)(a)(iv)
Notification ⁶	The Agreement requires alerting Parties and others when undertaking certain activities, including for example: Part II (MGRs): - Potential role for CLHM in fulfilling “Due regard” obligation for coastal States rights	Article 11(3)

⁶ As noted in footnote 5, “notification” is used here in the sense applied in Part III and Part IV of the Agreement, referring to informing other Parties of the availability of information.

	Part IV (EIAs): - Notice of a planned activity affecting BBNJ - Notice of scoping documents and draft EIAs - In case of unforeseen impacts or in case of breach of any conditions, notification of the CoP, other Parties and the public, including through the CLHM. Part V (CBTMT): - Notice of matching request or opportunity for CBTMT	Article 32 Article 33(5) Article 37(2) Articles 51(3)(a)(iv) and 51(3)(b)
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III. Technical (IT) requirements

The “backend” technical aspects of the functions required to fulfill the information-sharing obligations above are relatively simple to design and execute. Table 2 provides an overview of the main elements required to implement the basic functions assigned to the CLHM, including key considerations for an effective system.

Table 2: Necessary technical (IT) functions of the CLHM and corresponding articles of the BBNJ Agreement

Function	Description	Articles
Uploading, downloading, and modifying information	Upload and download functions provide a means of exchanging information and data among stakeholders and are a cornerstone of the BBNJ Agreement: - Uploading will allow users to contribute documents, reports, or data to the CLHM, ensuring that essential information is made available to other interested Parties and stakeholders. - Downloading will enable users to access relevant information, such as reports and decision documents.	Articles 12(2), 12(5), and 12(8) – Submit information required in pre-, post- collection, and utilization notifications. Article 15(4) – Make information on implementation of Part II available to the Access and Benefit-Sharing Committee, via the CLHM. Article 28(2)(a) – Make relevant information available during the national process. Article 28(2)(c) – Ensure EIA reports and relevant monitoring reports are available. Article 29(5) – Make EIAs available when conducted under a relevant instrument/framework. Article 29(6) – Monitoring and review reports must be published (uploaded) if not subject to monitoring and review under other instrument/framework and if criteria in 4(b)(i) are met. Articles 31(1)(a)(i) and (vi) – Upload information when a decision is made that an EIA is not required and any registration of views and recommendations by the STB.

		Articles 33(3) and (5) – Make draft EIAs available for comment and publish final EIA reports. Article 34(3) – Make decision documents outlining any conditions of approval (e.g., mitigation measures) publicly available. Article 36(2) – Make monitoring reports publicly available. Article 37(4)(d) – Make any concerns, notifications and recommendations by the STB publicly available via the CLHM. Article 37(6) – Publish reviews of the impacts of authorized activities and decision documents. Article 42(4) – Facilitation of self-assessment of needs and priorities. Article 51(3)(a)(iv) – Enable access, provide and disseminate information, including requests and opportunities for CBTMT. Article 51(3)(b) – Provide a platform for facilitating exchange of CBTMT needs and opportunities⁷ and facilitate access to related know-how and expertise (e.g., technical assistance database).
Notification mechanism	Several provisions require that Parties and the public receive timely notifications to keep stakeholders and Parties informed in real time of any actions, new information, deadlines for comment, etc. This can be accomplished through email alerts to focal points or in-system notifications.⁸ Given the importance of the timeliness of information subject to notification requirements, including deadlines for comment set by the BBNJ Agreement (e.g., Article 31(1)(a)(ii)), notifications should be sent out in real-time.	Article 11(3) – Parties shall endeavor to cooperate, as appropriate, including through the CLHM in a way that collection of MGRs of areas beyond national jurisdiction is carried out with due regard for coastal and other States. Article 32(1) – Parties shall ensure timely notification of a planned activity. Article 33(5) – The Secretariat shall ensure that all Parties are notified when reports are published. Article 37(2) – In case of impacts unforeseen in the EIA (or from a breach of any conditions), the Party shall notify the CoP, other Parties and the public. Article 37(5) – All States and stakeholders shall be kept informed through the CLHM (review of authorized activities and impacts).

⁷ A full matching function and a human element as envisioned in the Agreement will need to be integrated to maximize effectiveness, this will however require further time and resources to be fully operational.

⁸ Understood as a message that appears within the interface of a specific software application or platform.

User management (the process of creating, controlling, and maintaining user accounts, including managing user access rights, permissions, and credentials).	A user management system will help ensure secure and role-based access to information, maintain data integrity, and enable accountability through traceable user actions.	This important function is relevant across the Agreement.
Security	Login credentials for uploads are essential to ensure that uploaded data is secure and authentic. Credentials also support accountability by tracking user actions and by making it more difficult for malicious actors to insert viruses or corrupt or invalid data.	While log in credentials are essential for uploading information, downloading should not require a log in, as the provisions of Part IV permit wide access to posted information, reflecting the importance that the BBNJ Agreement, particularly Part IV, attaches to transparency and publicly available information.

IV. Key insights

Based on an evaluation of existing CLHMs and similar arrangements in other international agreements or processes, along with feedback from users of these mechanisms, several best practices and key features that could facilitate effective operationalization of the CLHM were identified:

1. Categorize available data in a user-friendly fashion and provide a filtering mechanism

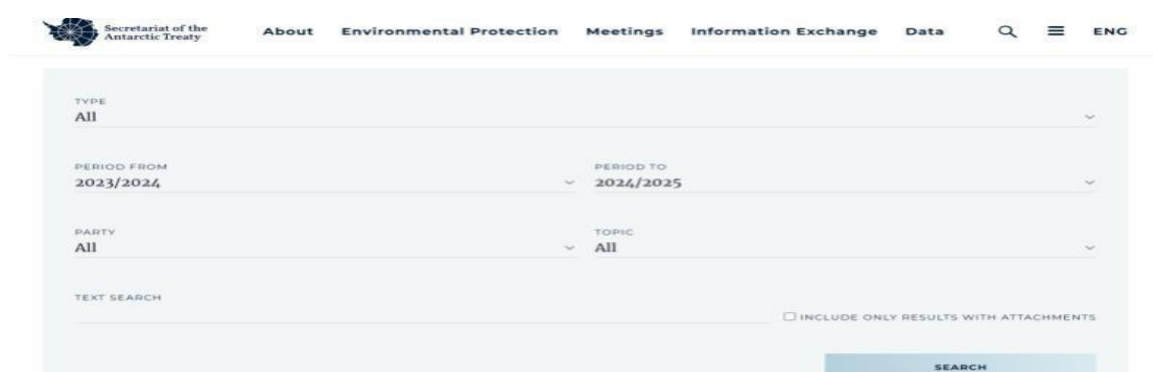
A key similarity between CLHM mechanisms under different international arrangements is the use of centralized platforms or repositories where data is categorized and then made publicly available through interactive dashboards, searchable databases, or dynamic maps. This thematic structure is useful in managing large datasets and enhancing user accessibility.

Many arrangements incorporate a filtering function, typically including criteria such as location (e.g., country), type of information, and other relevant parameters to ensure that the data shared is appropriately categorized and accessible in a user-friendly way. For example, the World Trade Organization (WTO) Notifications Portal allows users to filter information by country; the Antarctic Treaty EIA Database enables filtering by Party, topic (e.g., drilling or use of explosives), and time period (Figure 1); and the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) platform allows filtering by topic/policy area.

To support capacity-building and access to knowledge, the Basel, Rotterdam and Stockholm (BRS) Conventions host workshops and make them available through a searchable tab function (Figure 2). This allows users to filter workshops by convention, region, and year (the "Workshop Library") and better understand the objectives and outcomes of the workshops.

By enabling users to filter information based on specific criteria – such as region, year, or thematic focus – stakeholders can quickly identify relevant materials, including material related to past events.

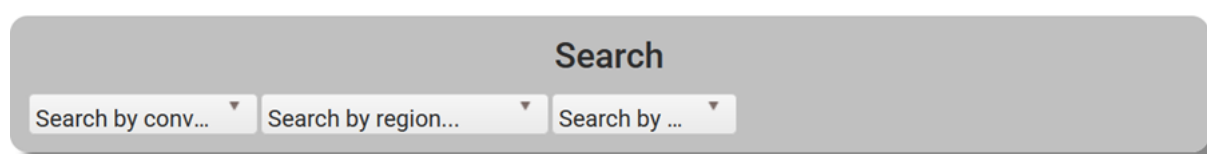
Figure 1: Filtering options for the Antarctic Treaty EIA Database



The screenshot shows the top navigation bar of the Antarctic Treaty EIA Database. The navigation bar includes the logo of the Secretariat of the Antarctic Treaty and links to About, Environmental Protection, Meetings, Information Exchange, Data, a search icon, a menu icon, and the language ENG. Below the navigation bar is a filtering section with the following options: TYPE (All), PERIOD FROM (2023/2024), PERIOD TO (2024/2025), PARTY (All), and TOPIC (All). There is also a TEXT SEARCH field and a checkbox labeled INCLUDE ONLY RESULTS WITH ATTACHMENTS. A blue SEARCH button is located at the bottom right of the filtering section.

Figure 2: BRS Conventions searchable workshop library

We invite you to visit the “Workshop library” below to learn more about the workshops planned and carried out:



The screenshot shows a search bar for the BRS Conventions searchable workshop library. The search bar has a grey background and a rounded rectangle shape. It features a large Search button in the center. Below the search bar are three dropdown menus: Search by conv..., Search by region..., and Search by ...

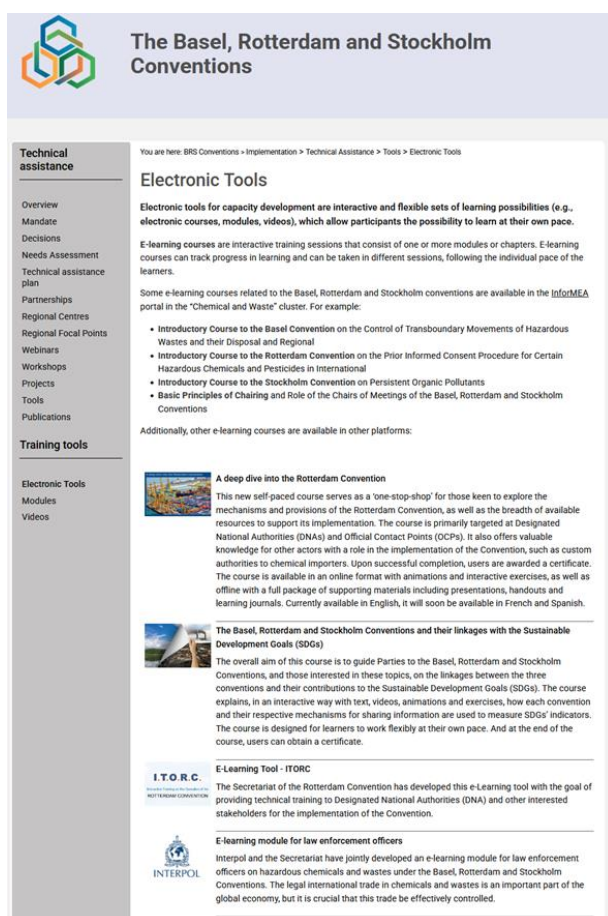
2. Provide dedicated overview webpages to help navigation

Several existing arrangements (e.g., the Convention on the Conservation of Migratory Species of Wild Animals (CMS) and the WTO) use dedicated webpages to provide users with a clear overview of available resources on the data platform, along with helpful resources on other platforms.

For example, [CMS has a dedicated page for capacity-building tools](#), featuring links that direct users to various resources (e.g., E-Community platform, information on workshops and other activities). The BRS Conventions platform also links e-learning material that is available on other platforms (Figure 3).

The WTO offers dedicated webpages that provide the user with an overview of general and specialized WTO-related technical assistance and training opportunities (e.g., trade policy courses, briefing sessions on specific issues). Additionally, the [WTO provides a dedicated e-learning platform](#) that offers online training on WTO Agreements, intended to support countries in building related capacity. The WTO notably has a dedicated institutional structure, the Institute for Training and Technical Cooperation ([ITTC](#)), that coordinates technical assistance and training across the organization.

Figure 3: BRS Conventions linking e-learning courses available on other platforms

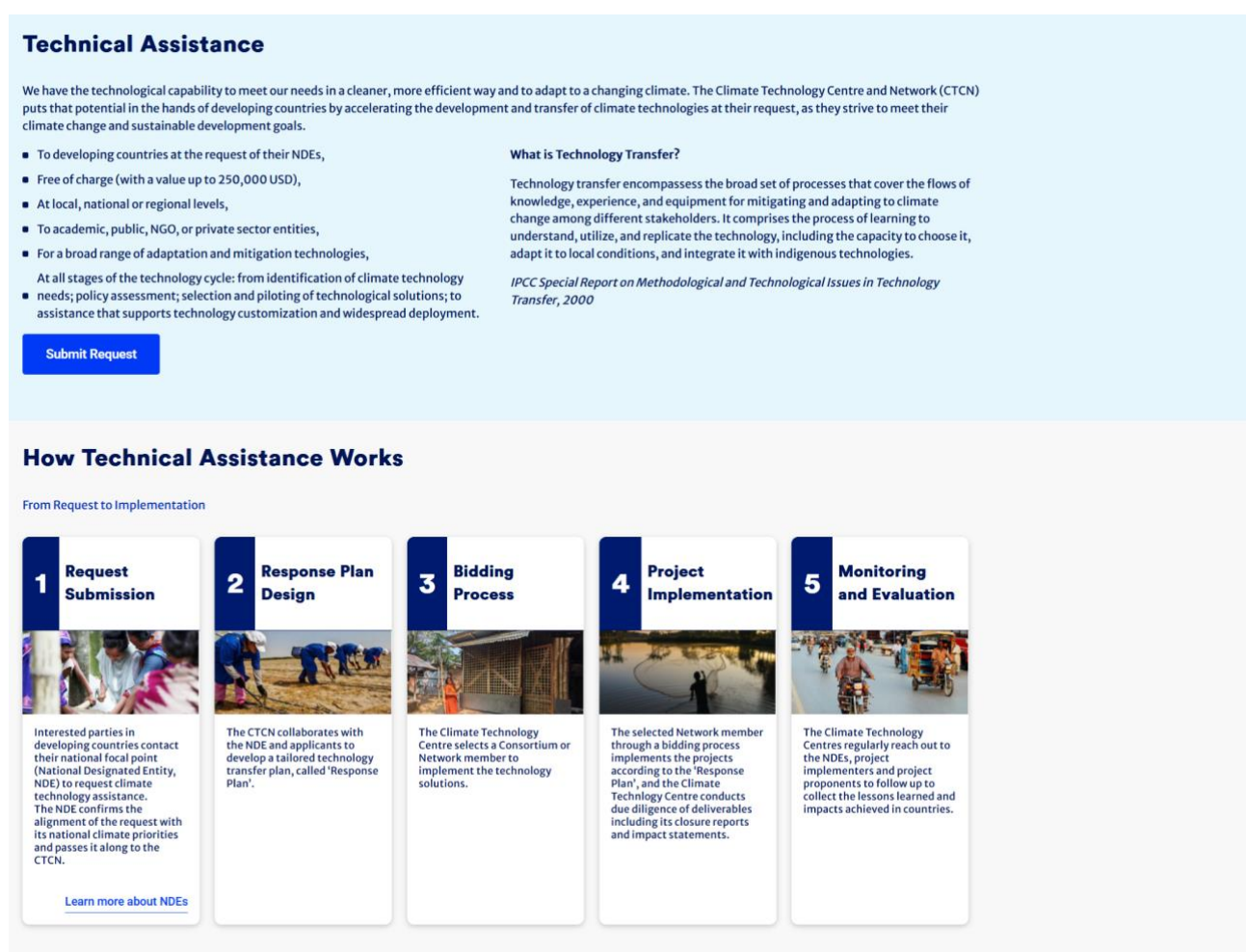


3. Provide a user-friendly platform to facilitate CBTMT

Various platforms provide useful examples of relatively streamlined capacity-building and technology transfer functions. For example, the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) Climate Technology Centre and Network (CTCN) provides the option for States to submit requests for assistance (Figure 4), with the CTCN offering the opportunity to do so using [pre-drafted templates](#). This approach facilitates the process of identifying and articulating capacity-building needs and making them accessible to potential providers of support. The user is guided throughout the process, much of which is conducted online, starting with the submission of a request.

An additional tool provided by the UNFCCC CTCN is an [active technical assistance database](#) that helps connect needs with available support. This database can be searched, for example, by sectors (e.g., forestry), by approach (e.g., ecosystems and biodiversity), by United Nations group (e.g., SIDS or Least Developed Countries), by objective (e.g., adaptation or mitigation), or by type of assistance (e.g., financing facilitation, recommendation for law, policy and regulations). The entries made to the database follow a similar pattern, whereby the country seeking assistance outlines the type of technical assistance sought, the expected outcomes, the requesting entity, and any documents (e.g., an official request form) already submitted. Additionally, the respective entry in the database often includes, for completed processes, a link to a closure report outlining the delivered outputs, the methodology employed and a dedicated section on “lessons learned”. Such reports foster transparency and accountability but moreover allow for peer learning and replicability.

Figure 4: UNFCCC CTCN technical assistance request step-by-step approach



V. Recommendations

Based on this review of CLHM-like platforms created under other international agreements and arrangements, we recommend incorporating the following into the design of the BBNJ CLHM. Recommendations relevant to the interim or pilot phase appear in **bold**.

- **The design of the mechanism must be in line with the requirements placed on Parties to the BBNJ Agreement. The initial interim operation of the CLHM must, at a minimum, include the functions necessary to enable Parties to meet their obligations under the Agreement.**
- **Dashboards and other visual tools should be integrated across all functions of the CLHM to improve user experience, accessibility, and engagement. Key information – such as documents, data, deadlines, and relevant contacts – should be presented in a clear, intuitive, and visually structured format that allows users to quickly navigate, filter, and access the content most relevant to them. Models such as the Antarctic Treaty EIA database offer helpful design inspiration.**
- **Pre-recorded videos explaining how to use the platform and how Parties can engage with it should be made available to eliminate the need for individual workshops and to accommodate new users efficiently (e.g., [United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs and the Response Planning and Monitoring Module](#)).**

- **Videos and other instructional materials should be supplemented with a close to real-time live-help mechanism. For example, the CBD Secretariat provides live staff support for Parties experiencing problems with its information sharing platform during office hours in Montreal or on the next business day. See Table 2 of the Annex for further details.**
- **Given the time-sensitive nature of information exchange requirements for some parts of the Agreement, including in the EIA process, (including deadlines for comment), it is critically important that uploaded information be made available directly through the CLHM in real time.**
- **An easy-to-navigate platform for capacity-building and technology transfer (e.g., through a dedicated webpage) should be accompanied by clear instructions on the process, including submission and review, and include capacity-building opportunities, including relevant programs, funding sources, and initiatives linked to the implementation of the Agreement that can be easily added to the website by sponsoring Parties or organizations.**
- A dedicated section should be created to host technical manuals, pre-recorded e-learning modules, and training materials, and to advertise upcoming workshops and webinars (which should be recorded for future use in a searchable format).
- A dedicated section (or a separate webpage) should clearly outline information exchange requirements (i.e., also noting the corresponding article) of different parts of the Agreement.
- A process for publication of CBTMT requests should be included, for example through an active technical assistance database that includes a brief description of assistance requests (see the [UNFCCC CTCN active technical assistance database](#) as well as Table 3 of the Annex).
- Links should be included to relevant capacity-building initiatives under other agreements, arrangements, or processes, in order to foster synergies, streamline access, and avoid duplication ([see for example BRS Conventions](#)).
- The mechanism should be constructed in a way that allows it to handle a growing volume of data and users over time, and adapt to evolving needs, including new functions.

VI. Conclusion

The BBNJ Agreement provides future Parties with clear guidance on the basic functions of the CLHM. It outlines when, how, and with whom different types of information must be shared, establishing well-defined obligations. Given the CLHM's central role in enabling Parties to meet their obligations from the moment the Agreement enters into force, these functions are critical, and most are relatively easy to implement. Existing examples from comparable mechanisms offer useful guidance for developing the BBNJ CLHM. While these tools may not be directly transferable in every case, they provide a solid foundation and practical inspiration as delegations continue efforts to operationalize the Mechanism. As negotiations advance, this initial guidance will be further refined and elaborated to ensure the CLHM fits the state of discussions.

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Annex: For further consideration

Table 1 of the Annex: Suggested minimum information for the dashboard/entry portal for Part IV

Type of information shown on dashboard/summary portal	Comments
Party making the submission	
Type of submission/stage of the EIA process	Given the variety of information, the BBNJ Agreement requires Parties to make available draft reports, final EIA reports, decision documents, monitoring reports, and reports on the review of authorized activities. The EIA CLHM should clearly specify which type of report has been made available.
Title of the document(s)	A clear title will make it easier to understand what the submission relates to.
Organization/agency/office/person responsible (including contact info)	This will allow users to identify which department and/or individuals within a proponent government has been tasked with managing the project.
Location of the activity	This will help other Parties identify whether a proposed project is relevant to their interests and requires closer attention and/or response. This will also help in identifying cumulative impacts.
Stage of process	The provisions related to EIAs under BBNJ contain several steps. Parties and other stakeholders should have a clear understanding of the stage at which the respective process is, especially in view of the participation opportunities during the consultation process. This includes screening, scoping, and the full EIA, as well as the specific obligations arising under Articles 29(4), 29(5), and 29(6).
Any deadlines associated with the activity	This should be clearly stated. For example, Article 31(1)(a)(ii) provides the opportunity for a Party to register its views within 40 days.
Period/timeframe of the activity	This will help identify when the activity is set to take place and its duration. Additionally, it will assist in identifying potential cumulative impacts, as Parties will gain an understanding of which activities are occurring, where, and for how long.
Decision	This will allow Parties to quickly determine whether an activity of concern or interest has been allowed to proceed or not.
Conditions of approval	This should not replace a more detailed treatment (i.e., uploading of decision documents), but will help other Parties understand under what circumstances the activity has been authorized.
List of documents related to the activity	All documents related to the activity should be listed and hyperlinked to streamline review.
Exchange requirements	While not necessarily required for every dashboard, it could be helpful to have a dedicated page that clearly outlines the requirements (e.g., exchange, sharing, or making available) derived from the BBNJ Agreement.

Table 2 of the Annex: Further components of the CLHM worth consideration

Category	Description
Online pre-recorded courses	Pre-recorded online courses on both the BBNJ CLHM and on specific matters relevant to Parties could be helpful in providing Parties with clear, accessible and consistent guidance on how to navigate the procedures. These courses could be permanently posted on the website (see for example CMS guidance on the implementation of the Convention) and can offer step-by-step instructions on how to make submissions in compliance with, for example, the exchange of information requirements of the Agreement, ensuring that all Parties – regardless of their technical capacity or resources – can effectively engage with the process. Having these permanently posted as a reference provides stakeholders the flexibility to learn at their own pace (and could alleviate challenges associated with finding appropriate times for a workshop for different time zones).
Interactive maps	Interactive maps showing where EIAs have been conducted, as well as where activities will take place, could assist Parties and stakeholders in identifying activities they may want to monitor, or ignore, as appropriate. These maps would provide transparency and allow Parties, stakeholders, and the public to easily track the locations of ongoing and planned activities in areas beyond national jurisdiction. This is particularly important when wanting to ensure that cumulative impacts on marine biodiversity are considered comprehensively (see BBNJ Articles 30(1)(a)(ii), 30(2)(e), and 31(1)(b), for example). By visualizing the distribution of activities and EIA submissions, the maps would allow for better coordination and help identify areas where multiple activities might overlap or interact, potentially exacerbating environmental pressures. They would support the assessment of cumulative impacts – something that is often challenging in the high seas – by enabling the consideration of not only individual activities but also the broader context in which they are taking place. This information can guide decision-making to avoid or minimize negative cumulative impacts on marine ecosystems, ensuring that conservation and sustainability goals under the BBNJ Agreement are met more effectively.
E-Community/forum	After having properly operationalized the key functions of the CLHM, in which sufficient experiences have been accumulated, Parties may wish to explore the idea of an e-community (see for example the CMS platform). This may be beneficial to BBNJ Parties as it would provide a dynamic platform for real-time engagement and collaboration. By allowing Parties to exchange experiences, share best practices, and ask questions, such a community would foster a stronger sense of cooperation and mutual learning. It would enable countries, especially those with limited resources, to access valuable knowledge and guidance from peers, facilitating more informed decision-making and promoting consistency in the implementation of BBNJ measures.
Infographics depicting the CLHM process	Infographics can simplify complex procedures, making it easier for Parties or potential Parties to understand the various functions and opportunities offered by the CLHM. In particular, clearly outlining the request for assistance function of the CLHM, can enhance accessibility and transparency by visually guiding users through each step of the process. This helps ensure that no Party is left behind in benefiting from available support for capacity-building and technology transfer.

Table 3 of the Annex: Information for database for ongoing and past technical assistance requests to facilitate broad assistance

The BBNJ Agreement sets a series of CBTMT-related objectives and obligations. In Article 41(2), the Agreement requires Parties to cooperate “at all levels and in all forms, including through partnerships with and involving all relevant stakeholders, such as, where appropriate, the private sector, civil society, and Indigenous Peoples and local communities as holders of traditional knowledge”. Article 42(4) underscores that CBTMT needs to be based on the needs and priorities of developing State Parties.

The CLHM plays several key roles in implementing Part V of the Agreement, most directly by facilitating needs-assessments together with the CBTMT Committee (as an alternative to self-assessed) under Article 42(4) and through matching capacity needs with opportunities (Article 51(3)(b)). Further, Article 42(1) requires Parties, within their capabilities, to ensure capacity-building for developing States Parties and to cooperate to achieve the transfer of marine technology. Article 51(3)(a)(iv) can be read as a way for Parties to discharge this obligation of conduct, by submitting requests and opportunities for CBTMT to the CLHM. It emphasizes that the CLHM should serve as a centralized platform to allow Parties to access, provide and disseminate information, including requests for CBTMT, as well as research collaboration and training opportunities.

To streamline such an effort, Parties may wish to integrate a dedicated active technical assistance database that provides an overview of past and ongoing technical assistance requests. Parties can use the CLHM to publish their assistance needs and to be better connected with potential support opportunities – arguably in a more targeted and timely manner. Such a tool would also promote transparency, coordination, and peer learning by showing what support has been provided and where gaps remain. It helps countries build on existing efforts, avoid duplication, and develop more informed, targeted requests for capacity-building and technology transfer.

This database could – based on Parties’ expressed preferences during the first session of the PrepCom – be strengthened by a robust human component that can support both requesters and providers of CBTMT with bilateral, on demand assistance, and conduct manual quality control of entries and matching functions. This should be a central component of future discussions.

The table below provides suggested minimum information that would make such a tool beneficial.

Type of information made available	Comments
Date of submission	The date of submission is important because it helps track the timeliness of requests, monitor progress, and prioritize support based on urgency or sequence. It also provides a reference point for evaluating response times and ensuring accountability in the delivery of assistance. This can help support the work of the monitoring and review work of the CBTMT Committee.
Country/Party making the request	Listing the Party making the request is important for ensuring transparency, tracking support geographically, and identifying specific capacity needs. It also enables tailored responses, facilitates coordination among donors and providers, and helps avoid duplication of efforts across regions or thematic areas.
Objective of the request	Identifying the objective of the request clarifies specific needs and goals, enabling more tailored and effective support. This improves matching by helping providers understand exactly what assistance is required, ensuring resources are directed where they can have the greatest impact.
Description	A description is important because it provides detailed context about the request, helping potential supporters fully understand the issue and its complexity. This enables more accurate assessment, better advice, and more appropriate and effective assistance.

Delivery format (e.g., in-person or online training, equipment transfer, policy advisory support)	This helps the users quickly identify how support was or can be provided, facilitating better planning and matching of assistance to needs. It also enables analysis of which methods are most effective in different contexts, improving future capacity-building efforts. For recorded formats, providing a link allows others interested in similar assistance to access, review, and learn from the materials.
Thematic focus	Including thematic focus helps organize and classify assistance by key subject areas, making it easier for users to find relevant support and for providers to identify gaps. This likewise ensures alignment with specific priorities of the BBNJ Agreement and facilitates targeted, effective capacity-building.
Outcome and lessons learned	This category would help document the impact and effectiveness of assistance, providing valuable insights for improving future support. It also promotes transparency, accountability, and the sharing of best practices across Parties.
Key documents	Having all relevant documents (including request forms and closing reports that could be based on pre-designed templates) in one place provides easy access to important reports, guidelines, and resources related to the assistance. This supports knowledge sharing, helps users understand the context and results, and enables replication of successful approaches.